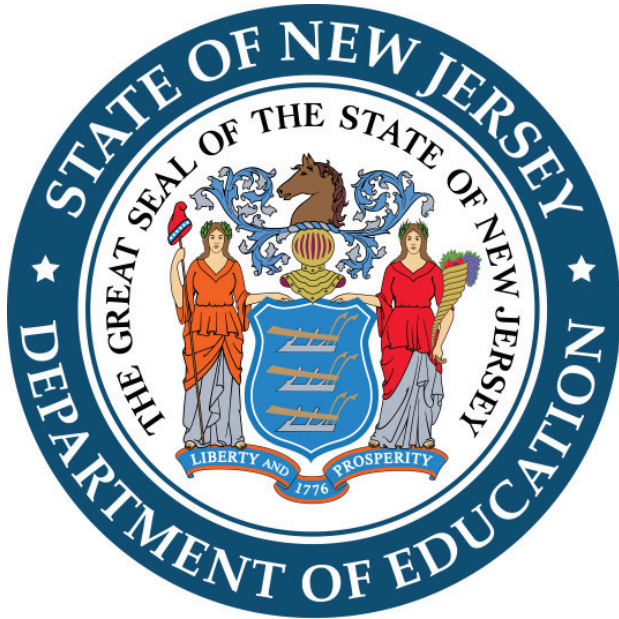




New Jersey
Student Learning
Assessments-Adaptive

Practice Test

English Language Arts

Grade 4

Student Name _____

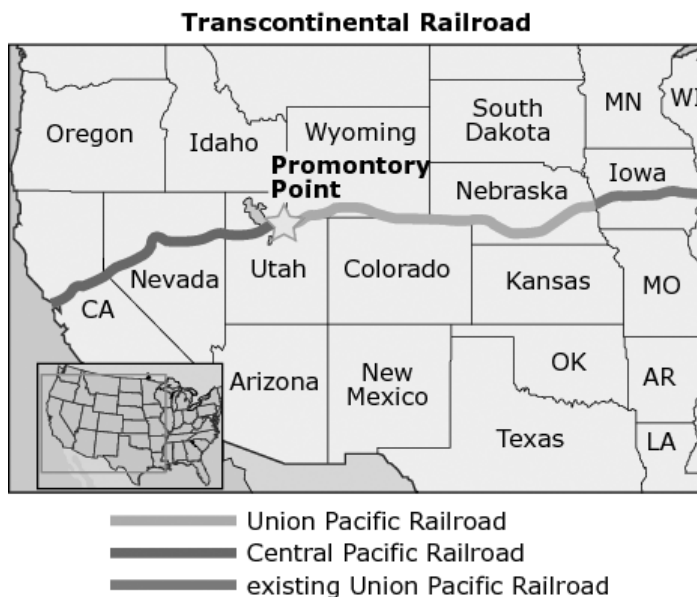
Directions:

Today, you will take the Grade 4 English Language Arts Practice Test. If you do not know the answer to a question, skip it and go on to the next question. If you have time, go back to the questions you skipped and try to answer them before turning in your Student Test Booklet.

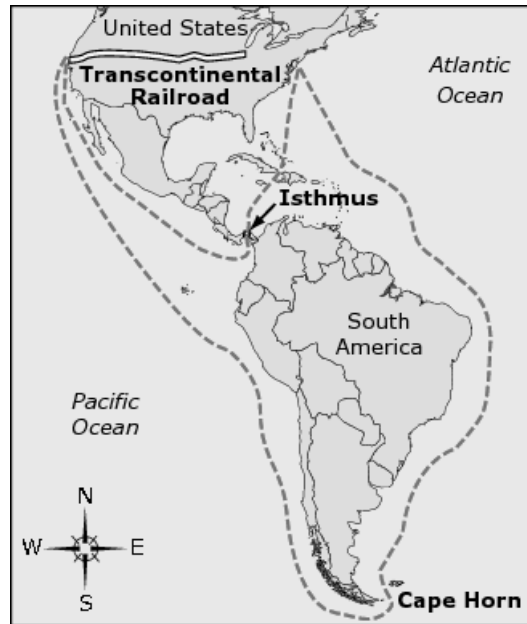
1. Read each passage and question. Then, follow the directions to answer each question.
2. Fill in the circle next to your answer choice or choices.
 - If you change your answer, make sure you erase your old answer completely.
 - Do not cross out or make any marks on the other choices.
3. One of the questions will ask you to write your answer.
 - Write your answer in the space provided in your Student Test Booklet.
 - Be sure to keep your answer within the provided space.

A Transcontinental Railroad

by Mark Clemens



- 1 The idea of a **transcontinental** railroad came into being when California and the western territories were beginning to be settled by large groups of people. A group of businessmen predicted that a railroad which connected the east coast with the west would make a good deal of money in trade. They even expected to transport goods brought to California from China.
- 2 At first, the building of a transcontinental railroad seemed an impossible task. In 1862, President Lincoln signed a bill which gave the railroad companies special land grants and government bonds to help pay for the job. Even so, the owners of the companies had to find ways to raise more money.
- 3 The Central Pacific Railroad began construction in Sacramento, California in 1863. The Union Pacific began in Omaha, Nebraska in December of the same year. In less than four years, 1,776 miles of track were laid across a wilderness.
- 4 Both companies had tremendous difficulty getting their supplies. The Central Pacific had to ship their equipment from the Atlantic coast. The only way to do this was to send it either across the **Isthmus of Panama** or around **Cape Horn** to San Francisco. This was very expensive, and took a long time.



- 5 The Union Pacific had their own problems. At first, they had to ship their supplies and equipment up the Missouri River by steamboat, then carry them overland by stagecoach and in wagons. Later, they were able to send supplies along the tracks they had laid, but this was slow, and hardly an improvement. All the digging and carrying, pushing and pulling had to be done by men with picks and shovels, wheelbarrows, wagons and mules. It took the labor of hundreds of men . . . to complete this incredible task. Work continued for many years after 1869. Even though the tracks were laid, there was still work to be done **grading** and **banking** along the way.
- 6 Ten years after the **Golden Spike Ceremony**, Robert Louis Stevenson traveled across America by train. You can read in the descriptions entered in his journal that trains were still far from comfortable. But over the years, they did improve. For a time, they were a popular way to travel and an inexpensive way to ship things.
- 7 Railroad companies began losing money when the automobile and the truck were developed. Many companies were forced out of business. Today, it is just as common to see an abandoned railroad track as it is to see a used one. But the story of railroads does not end here. Perhaps . . . we can look forward to using the rails again, and the development of a new and improved technology.

Glossary

transcontinental: going across a continent—in this case, North America

Isthmus of Panama: a narrow strip of land connecting North and South America

Cape Horn: the southernmost tip of South America

grading: giving a surface a slope

banking: building a railway curve with the outer rail higher than the inner rail

Golden Spike Ceremony: ceremony celebrating the completion of the transcontinental railroad held in Promontory Point, Utah

Excerpt from "The First Transcontinental Railroad, May 10, 1869" by Mark Clemens. Copyright © 1980 by Cobblestone Publishing. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing via Copyright Clearance Center.

1. Why were the railroad companies able to begin construction of the transcontinental railroad in 1863?
- (A) They agreed on where the railroad tracks would go.
 - (B) They received land grants and money from the government.
 - (C) Materials to build the railroad arrived in California from China.
 - (D) People were moving to California and wanted an easier way to travel back east.
2. What does the word bill mean as it is used in paragraph 2?
- (A) a plan for a law
 - (B) a piece of paper money
 - (C) a list of the cost of items
 - (D) an advertisement for an event
3. Select **three** sentences that should be included in a summary of the passage.
- (A) Railroad travel became more popular after authors began writing about it.
 - (B) The transcontinental railroad connected the east coast and the west coast.
 - (C) Businessmen wanted goods from the transcontinental railroad to be brought from China.
 - (D) Both companies that constructed the transcontinental railroad experienced many difficulties.
 - (E) It was more difficult for workers to finish the transcontinental railroad after the first step, laying down the tracks, was completed.
 - (F) For many years after the transcontinental railroad was completed, trains were a popular and inexpensive way to move goods.

4. What does the gold star on the first map help the reader understand about the transcontinental railroad?
- Ⓐ the point of the United States where western territories began
 - Ⓑ the location where the Union Pacific and Central Pacific Railroads met
 - Ⓒ the city where trade between the United States and other countries would take place
 - Ⓓ the place where the Union Pacific and Central Pacific Railroads picked up their materials
5. What information does the author use to support the idea that building the transcontinental railroad seemed like an impossible task?
- Ⓐ The Union Pacific had to ship its supplies by steamboat up the Missouri River.
 - Ⓑ Even with help to pay for the project, the railroad companies still had to raise more money.
 - Ⓒ After the tracks were laid, help was still needed from wagons and mules to move the supplies and tools.
 - Ⓓ Businessmen who had no idea how to build railroads thought that they could transport goods from China to California.
6. Fill in the circle **before** the sentence that supports the idea that the transcontinental railroad was important to many people.
- 6 Ⓐ Ten years after the Golden Spike Ceremony, Robert Louis Stevenson traveled across America by train. Ⓑ You can read in the descriptions entered in his journal that trains were still far from comfortable. Ⓒ But over the years, they did improve. Ⓓ For a time, they were a popular way to travel and an inexpensive way to ship things.

7. How does the author support his point about why the railroad companies went out of business?
- Ⓐ by explaining how the cost of land affected the railroad companies
 - Ⓑ by explaining how difficult it was for the railroad companies to raise money
 - Ⓒ by explaining how changes in the way people traveled affected railroad companies
 - Ⓓ by explaining how much people complained to the railroad companies about the trains

8. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is the main idea of the passage?

- Ⓐ Two railroad companies competed to build the first transcontinental railroad.
- Ⓑ Two railroad companies tried and failed to improve traveling by train across the transcontinental railroad.
- Ⓒ Two railroad companies and the United States government built a transcontinental railroad for settlers moving west.
- Ⓓ Two railroad companies worked together to build and benefit from a transcontinental railroad across the United States.

Part B

Which detail from the passage supports the answer in Part A?

- Ⓐ “. . . a railroad which connected the east coast with the west would make a good deal of money in trade.” (paragraph 1)
- Ⓑ “In 1862, President Lincoln signed a bill which gave the railroad companies special land grants and government bonds to help pay for the job.” (paragraph 2)
- Ⓒ “You can read in the descriptions entered in his journal that trains were still far from comfortable.” (paragraph 6)
- Ⓓ “. . . we can look forward to using the rails again, and the development of a new and improved technology.” (paragraph 7)

Passage 1: Why Leaves Change Color

retold by Margi Preus

- 1 When Nanabozho was a boy and the earth was new, his grandmother, Nokomis, made him some paints. She mixed dyes out of moonlight and shadows, snowflakes and sand. She made silky blues from night and soft greens from reindeer moss. She squeezed the sparkle out of shooting stars. Then she put all the colors into pots and put the pots into a pouch for her grandson.
- 2 "Make beauty, Nanabozho," she said. "Paint the flowers today."
- 3 Nanabozho skipped off to a field full of pale white coneflowers. He dipped his brush into the purple paint pot. Then he painted the petals gently, one by one, being careful not to slop over the edges. . . .
- 4 Nanabozho put spots on Salamander. He painted a red cap on Woodpecker and a black cap on Chickadee.
- 5 Then he noticed Sparrow, perched on a low tree branch.
- 6 "Poor Sparrow," Nanabozho cried, "not a shimmery feather nor a speck of bright color . . ."
- 7 Sparrow hopped onto a higher branch. . . .
- 8 "I want to make you beautiful!" . . .
- 9 He reached out to grab Sparrow, but the little bird darted away. Nanabozho lost his balance and tumbled backward. His shirt snagged on a branch, and there Nanabozho swung.
- 10 But the paints and dyes! They spilled! Every pot of twilight, dawn, and sunset. Every pot of flame and fire, sunlight and starlight, gold and silver. And worse, Wind chose that very moment to rush over to see what was happening. Wind's sudden *whoosh* spattered the falling colors all over the trees.
- 11 The trees shrieked, "Look what you've done! Our lovely green leaves!"
- 12 "I'm sorry!" said Nanabozho. "It was an accident." . . .
- 13 All the birds and animals were gathering to see what had happened. They stared up at the trees. . . .
- 14 "Beautiful," croaked Frog. Chickadee twittered, "So pretty! So pretty!"
- 15 The trees hushed their shaking branches and listened. Were they really prettier now? Oak blushed deep red. Aspen's golden leaves glowed.

- 16 Then Maple whispered, "Don't feel bad, Nanabozho. I think I will like my new colors."
- 17 "Thank you, Maple," said Nanabozho. Soon the other trees decided their bright new colors were not so bad after all. They forgave Nanabozho, too.
- 18 Now, every year we remember when Nanabozho spilled his paints and made the trees so beautiful. And every year, Maple, the one who forgave Nanabozho first, is the prettiest of all.

Excerpt from "Why Leaves Change Color," an Ojibwe story retold by Margi Preus. Copyright © 2008 by Cricket Media. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing via Copyright Clearance Center.

Passage 2: How Ma-ui Fished Up a Great Island

retold by Pat Betteley

Characters: Narrator 1, Narrator 2, Narrator 3, Ma-ui, Brother 1, Brother 2, Mother (Hina-of-the-Fire), Sister (Hina-of-the-Sea)

- 19 **Narrator 1:** Now, Ma-ui (MOW-ee) had done many great deeds, and he was a hero to many. But in his very own house, his brothers did not think very much of him.
- 20 **Brother 1:** Why do we bother bringing you along when you never catch any fish? . . .
- 21 **Narrator 2:** Although he wasn't a great fisherman, Ma-ui had discovered many of the tools his brothers used every day. For example, fish could often wiggle away from the smooth spearheads men once used. Ma-ui put barbs on his spearhead that held the fish. After that, his brothers could catch many more fish than before. Still, they complained about Ma-ui to their mother, Hina-of-the-Fire. . . .
- 22 **Ma-ui:** I must do some wonderful fishing so my brothers won't think that I am lazy and shiftless. First, I'll need a fishhook that is different from any fishhook that has ever been used in the world before. I know just where to find the best bone for my hook.
- 23 **Narrator 2:** . . . Ma-ui hid his hook, bait, and line and went down to his brothers' canoe. The three brothers set off to fish.
- 24 **Brother 1:** Where are those great fish you promised us, Ma-ui? . . .

- 25 **Narrator 1:** Then Ma-ui had an idea. He put a sail on the canoe. They sailed and they sailed farther out to sea. Finally, Ma-ui let down his line with the magic hook baited with the alae bird. The hook, named “Ma-nai-i-ka-lani,” went down, down, down. . . .
- 26 **Narrator 1:** When Ma-ui let down the magic hook, Hina-of-the-Sea dived down and put the hook into the mouth of Old One Tooth who holds fast the land to the bottom of the sea. . . .
- 27 **Ma-ui:** Paddle your hardest, brothers, for the great fish is caught.
- 28 **Narrator 2:** Ma-ui and his brothers paddled their hardest, but a great weight grew behind the canoe. It became harder and harder to pull. . . .
- 29 **Narrator 3:** Finally, one of Ma-ui’s brothers looked back. He screamed out in fright at what he saw. A whole land was rising up behind them, with mountains upon it. . . .
- 30 **Narrator 1:** Ma-ui had fished up what would have been a mainland. But because his brother dropped the paddle and the line broke, only an island came out of the water. . . .
- 31 **Narrator 2:** And in spite of what his brothers say, everyone on every island in the Great Ocean knows that Ma-ui fished up a great island. . . .

Excerpt from “How Ma-ui Fished Up a Great Island,” a play based on a Hawaiian folktale retold by Pat Betteley.
Copyright © 2019 by Cricket Media. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing via Copyright Clearance Center.

9. Read these sentences from Passage 1.

"He dipped his brush into the purple paint pot. Then he painted the petals gently, one by one, being careful not to slop over the edges." (paragraph 3)

What do these sentences tell the reader about Nanabozho?

- Ⓐ He is considering becoming an artist when he grows up.
 - Ⓑ He is serious about the task his grandmother has given him.
 - Ⓒ He wants to practice painting flowers before painting the birds.
 - Ⓓ He knows that his grandmother will want to see the work he has done.
10. In Passage 1, which sentences show what makes Nanabozho want to paint the animals? Select **two** answers.
- Ⓐ "Nanabozho put spots on Salamander." (paragraph 4)
 - Ⓑ "Then he noticed Sparrow, perched on a low tree branch." (paragraph 5)
 - Ⓒ "'Poor Sparrow,' Nanabozho cried, 'not a shimmery feather nor a speck of bright color . . .'" (paragraph 6)
 - Ⓓ "'I want to make you beautiful!'" (paragraph 8)
 - Ⓔ "Chickadee twittered, 'So pretty! So pretty!'" (paragraph 14)

11. Read the sentences from Passage 1.

“Every pot of twilight, dawn, and sunset. Every pot of flame and fire, sunlight and starlight, gold and silver.” (paragraph 10)

What does the language in these sentences suggest?

- Ⓐ Nanabozho’s paints are very expensive.
- Ⓑ The paint Nanabozho uses damages the trees.
- Ⓒ The paints Nanabozho has are brilliant in color.
- Ⓓ Nanabozho’s paints are brightest in the morning.

12. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is a theme of Passage 1?

- Ⓐ Nature should be protected.
- Ⓑ Family members help one another.
- Ⓒ Careless people may cause problems.
- Ⓓ Accidents can lead to unexpected results.

Part B

Which detail supports the theme in Part A?

- Ⓐ "Then she put all the colors into pots and put the pots into a pouch for her grandson." (paragraph 1)
- Ⓑ "He painted a red cap on Woodpecker and a black cap on Chickadee." (paragraph 4)
- Ⓒ "All the birds and animals were gathering to see what had happened." (paragraph 13)
- Ⓓ "Soon the other trees decided their bright new colors were not so bad after all." (paragraph 17)

13. Which sentence from Passage 2 shows that Ma-ui’s brothers doubt him?

- Ⓐ “But in his very own house, his brothers did not think very much of him.” (paragraph 19)
- Ⓑ “After that, his brothers could catch many more fish than before.” (paragraph 21)
- Ⓒ “Ma-ui hid his hook, bait, and line and went down to his brothers’ canoe.” (paragraph 23)
- Ⓓ “Ma-ui and his brothers paddled their hardest, but a great weight grew behind the canoe.” (paragraph 28)

14. Read the sentence from Passage 2.

31 **Narrator 2:** And in spite of what his brothers say, everyone on every island in the Great Ocean knows that Ma-ui fished up a great island.

What does the sentence reveal about Ma-ui’s brothers?

- Ⓐ They still do not show respect to Ma-ui.
- Ⓑ They are afraid of the island Ma-ui has fished up.
- Ⓒ They want to tell others about what Ma-ui did on the boat.
- Ⓓ They are not sure how people on the other islands feel about Ma-ui.

15. This question has two parts. First, answer Part A. Then, answer Part B.

Part A

What is a theme of Passage 2?

- Ⓐ Helpers often come from surprising places.
- Ⓑ It is important to be calm when trouble arises.
- Ⓒ Quick thinking does not always lead to success right away.
- Ⓓ Heroes are sometimes not recognized by those closest to them.

Part B

Which sentence from Passage 2 supports the theme in Part A?

- Ⓐ "But in his very own house, his brothers did not think very much of him." (paragraph 19)
- Ⓑ "Although he wasn't a great fisherman, Ma-ui had discovered many of the tools his brothers used every day." (paragraph 21)
- Ⓒ "I know just where to find the best bone for my hook." (paragraph 22)
- Ⓓ "Paddle your hardest, brothers, for the great fish is caught." (paragraph 27)

16. How does nature play a role in the development of the theme of **both** passages?

- (A) The events in both passages cause lasting changes in nature.
- (B) The settings of both passages are made more beautiful by nature.
- (C) The characters in both passages are afraid of the power of nature.
- (D) The language used in both passages shows the hidden dangers of nature.

17. The two passages have different structures. Fill in **one** circle in each row to show whether each feature is used in Passage 1, in Passage 2, or in both passages.

	Passage 1	Passage 2	Both
dialogue from different characters	(A)	(B)	(C)
description of a beautiful setting	(D)	(E)	(F)
the use of identified narrators	(G)	(H)	(I)

Writing**Directions:**

Read the writing prompt and sources. Then write your final essay on pages 25 through 27. Check over your essay when you are finished.

Writing Prompt

The teachers in your school are planning activities for students. Write an essay for your teacher in which you give your opinion about whether students should do activities to improve schools. Use information from the sources in your essay.

Manage your time carefully so that you can

- read the sources;
- plan your response;
- write your response; and
- revise and edit your response.

Be sure to include

- an introduction;
- support for your opinion using information from the sources; and
- a conclusion that is related to your opinion.

Your response should be in the form of a multiparagraph essay. Write your response in the space provided.

Should Students Do Activities to Improve Schools?

Source 1: Starting with a Clean Slate . . . and a Lot of Paint!

by Marcia Amidon Lusted

- 1 Look at the outside walls of your school. Are they nice looking? Clean? Freshly painted? Maybe, but maybe not. For many kids who live in the Los Angeles area, the walls around them are covered with graffiti or peeling paint, or they are just plain dull. But thanks to Operation Clean Slate, kids have been getting involved and turning those ugly walls into something bright and interesting.
- 2 It all started when a man named Michael Howard was driving to work. . . . He noticed a white wall with red graffiti all over it. Soon he was noticing more and more graffiti everywhere he went. Howard was a teacher . . . and finally one day he asked his students why they messed up the walls of their neighborhoods with graffiti. The answer surprised him. Writing on walls made them feel important, and it gave them a feeling of recognition, they told him. From there Howard started thinking about what these kids could do to the walls instead of plastering them with graffiti. Why not create public art, something beautiful and lasting? And that's how Operation Clean Slate (OCS) was born
- 3 Eighteen years later, OCS has helped kids paint more than 700 murals just in the Los Angeles area alone, as well as more in other countries. More than 24,000 volunteers have helped them. Most volunteers are kids who are helping to make their own schools and public buildings more beautiful. OCS works with any school to help them paint their own mural. Once the school decides what they want to paint and where, and raises the money for paint and other supplies, OCS helps them get started. It usually takes anywhere between 10 and 50 volunteers to paint a mural, and from one to 10 days of painting time.

- 4 Murals can be of anything. Not only do they involve kids and make schools more beautiful, but they also carry important messages. . . . They can boost school spirit and make kids feel better about their school. Colorful walls reduce graffiti vandalism and make people feel better when they look at them!

"Starting with a Clean Slate . . . and a Lot of Paint!" by Marcia Amidon Lusted, from *Faces*. Copyright © 2011 by Carus Publishing Company. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing Company via Copyright Clearance Center.

Source 2: Growing a Schoolyard Garden

adapted from an article by
Jeannine Pao

- 5 The bell rings. Finally, it's lunchtime. Do you know where your lunch came from? Around the country, there are programs that teach kids to think about where they get their food.
- 6 The students . . . created their garden from scratch. In an abandoned lot next to their school, they pulled weeds Under the weeds and junk, the soil they found was not in good condition for growing food. So the students planted something called cover crops. (When these plants grow, they get plowed back into the soil to provide food for the soil. It's like growing your own fertilizer!) The students also added lots of compost. This rich soil is produced when vegetation (leaves, grass clippings, banana peels, apple cores, and more) rots and breaks down. Adding compost is a great way to enrich garden soil.
- 7 Sure, gardening is hard work. But the students have a lot of fun, too. . . . Not only do they get to play in the dirt, they have to.
- 8 But the best part of the garden experience is eating, of course. The students eat peas in their pods and tomatoes right off the vine. They snack on berries and edible flowers as they work. (This is safe because the Edible Schoolyard doesn't use any chemical fertilizers or pesticides.) Once food has been harvested in the garden, students take it to the kitchen classroom. Here, the students do everything—from chopping and cooking to setting the table with tablecloths, silverware, and flowers from the garden. Each day, the students make delicious, healthy dishes. They sit down together to share what they have prepared. After eating what they've made, they take the kitchen scraps out to the garden where they're used for compost to help grow more food.

"Growing a Schoolyard Garden" adapted from an article by Jeannine Pao, from *AppleSeeds*. Copyright © 2008 by Carus Publishing Company. Reprinted by permission of Carus Publishing Company via Copyright Clearance Center.

Source 3: Keep Students Focused on Schoolwork

by Luz Chavez

- 9 Having students do jobs around school, such as gardening and painting, sounds like a good idea at first. Students learn how to be responsible. They practice working in groups. They keep the school looking great. However, there are many reasons these jobs should be left to adults.
- 10 Students lead busy lives. They have classwork, homework, after-school activities, and chores at home. Many parents are already concerned that their children have too much homework. Teachers often worry about having enough classroom time to teach and prepare students. Many kids need tutoring and this extra time spent outside of the classroom would keep them from being able to get help. Students' classroom time is precious. Schools should focus on preparing students for academic success.
- 11 Having to do all of that work outside of class would also cut down on a student's time to have fun. Many kids like to unwind by playing video games, watching their favorite TV show, or playing after school sports or other school activities.
- 12 The need for supervision is another reason not to have students do jobs to improve school grounds. Schools don't have to take care of or closely watch adult workers. Adults know to work carefully. They know how quickly or slowly to do a job. They know how to handle different types of tools. They are less likely to hurt themselves or make mistakes.
- 13 A hallway painted by an adult is likely to look better than a hallway painted by a child. Sure, a child can decorate a hallway. But painting a hallway is a job for a professional. Professionals won't leave spots or stains. They won't accidentally paint on windows. Also, it is not the kids' job to clean up the school. While some kids may like this, others will not enjoy it. Students have a job to do well in school. A painter has a job to paint. Kids should not be doing that.
- 14 Yes, school gardens and cleanup efforts, such as picking up trash or painting walls, can teach children the value of work. But with the many dangers these tasks present, the jobs are better left in the hands of adults. When in school, students should focus on learning in the classroom.

"Keep Students Focused on Schoolwork" by Luz Chavez. Written for educational purposes.

[illegible]

FINAL COPY

[illegible]

FINAL COPY

Lined area for writing.



Paper Practice Test Answer and Alignment Document: ELA

Grade 4 Reading

Passage: A Transcontinental Railroad

Item Sequence	Answer Key	Standards Alignment
1	B	RI.IT.4.3
2	A	L.VL.4.2
3	B, D, F	RI.CI.4.2
4	B	RI.MF.4.6
5	B	RI.AA.4.7
6	<i>The student's response contains the following selection:</i> For a time, they were a popular way to travel and an inexpensive way to ship things.	RI.CR.4.1
7	C	RI.AA.4.7
8	Part A: D Part B: A	RI.CI.4.2

Passage 1: Why Leaves Change Color

Passage 2: How Ma-ui Fished Up a Great Island

Item Sequence	Answer Key					Standards Alignment
9	B					RL.IT.4.3
10	C, D					RL.CR.4.1
11	C					L.VI.4.3
12	Part A: D Part B: D					RL.CI.4.2
13	A					RL.IT.4.3
14	A					RL.IT.4.3
15	Part A: D Part B: A					RL.CI.4.2
16	A					RL.CT.4.8
17			Passage 1	Passage 2	Both	RL.TS.4.4
		dialogue from different characters			☒	
		description of a beautiful setting	☒			
		the use of identified narrators		☒		

Grade 4 Writing

Source 1: Starting with a Clean Slate... and a Lot of Paint

Source 2: Growing a Schoolyard Garden

Source 3: Keep Students Focused on Schoolwork

Item Sequence	Answer Key	Standards Alignment
1	Refer to the grades 4-5 opinion writing rubric.	W.AW.4.1